

CDN Incident Alert: 0038. TLP: CLEAR			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	EU	Doppelganger continues operations in German, French, Hebrew and Ukrainian	10/01/2024	1

Summary

- Between 28 December and 5 January, 288 Doppelganger tweets were identified.
- 24 fake articles were disseminated in French, German, Hebrew, and Ukrainian.
- Key narratives include economic ruin in France, Germany and Israel, corruption in Ukraine, Israel being unable to maintain its position in the region, and allies turning away from supporting Ukraine.
- Geolocation redirection is still not working for Doppelganger.
- All articles except one link back to the same Russian IP address connected to a UK legal entity owned by a Ukrainian national.
- This UK entity should be investigated further and the alert was sent to X, media, and European governments.

Incident

During the time between 28 December and 5 January, 288 Tweets were identified as likely parts of Operation Doppelganger. Out of these tweets, 230 had Doppelganger URLs and 58 did not. Given the sanctions on SDA, the producer of Doppelganger tweets, these tweets are potentially illegal content.

24 separate fake articles were identified. The Doppelganger Domains used are: “leparisien(.)fyi”, “lepoint(.)top”, “welt(.)pm”, “news(.)walla(.)top”, “obozrevatel(.)ltd”, and “unian(.)cx”.

All articles except one link back to the IP Address 83(.)217(.)208(.)10, which is located in Russia. According to URL scanner, this IP is affiliated with “Partner Hosting LTD”, a UK-based entity, which according to the UK Government information services is owned by a Denys Hnoievyi, a Ukrainian national born in 2005, on the listed correspondence address 71-75, Shelton Street, Covent Garden, London, United Kingdom, WC2H 9JQ.

Narrative

Macron has led France to ruin; France is facing economic disaster; Africa is reorientating away from France; macron is risking French lives in Ukraine; Ukraine cannot win the war; Trump will dominate Europe;

Germans are being impoverished; Sanctions against Russia and Support for Ukraine will hurt the German economy;

Israel’s position is weakened and the middle east is in chaos; Israeli institutions are to blame for the cost of living in Israel; Israel is unable to handle additional conflicts; Israelis cannot afford Hannukah celebrations and pastries;

Foreign Policy Support for Ukraine and against Israel lost the election for the Democrats; The US is antisemitic and Americans welcome the ongoing genocide of Jews;

Ukraine will conscript 18 year old; France is negotiating an end of the war without including Ukraine in the negotiations; Ukraine has lost heating and power; Ukrainians want elections in spite of the war; Allies are turning against Ukraine; Ukraine is corrupt;

Impact

Reach: According to X’s API, the tweets garnered 1,200,638 views, but this data is unreliable.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Smear](#) - Smear EU member state governments, Ukraine, the US and Israel.

Objective: [Divide](#) - The influence is trying to undermine cooperation and trust between the EU, US, Ukraine and Israel.

[Conceal Network Identity](#) – The accounts are not revealing that they are part of a larger network.

[Conduct Server Redirect](#) - The posts contain redirect URLs that obfuscate them to avoid content moderation.

[Domain Asset](#) – The influence operation is using look-alike domains to give legitimacy to the influence operation.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Action to be taken: Alert spoofed platforms, sent alert to European Governments and X.

Recommendations: Investigate the role of Partner Hosting LTD in Doppelganger.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
N/A	Doppelganger, Germany, France, Israel, Ukraine,	Link (request access needed for non-A4E accounts)	Joel Haglund, Aurelio Chifor, Or Yacobi, Alliance4Europe	X	